

SKUNKS AND RELATIVES

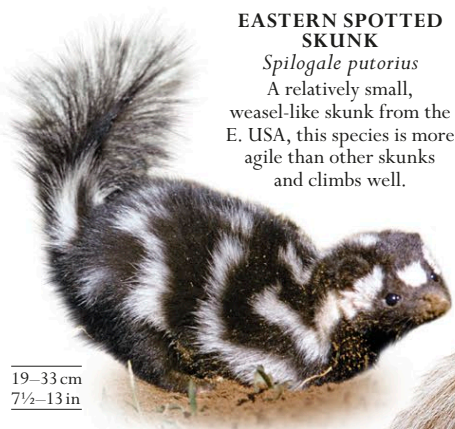
This small group of cat-sized mammals from the Americas is named for its most distinctive behaviour – that of squirting foul-smelling musk at an aggressor. The family name, Mephitidae, comes from the Latin word for “bad smell”.



PALAWAN STINK BADGER
Mydaus marchei

This bumbling cousin of the American skunks is found only on the Philippine islands of Palawan and Calamian. It eats mainly invertebrates.

32–49 cm
12½–19½ in



EASTERN SPOTTED SKUNK
Spilogale putorius

A relatively small, weasel-like skunk from the E. USA, this species is more agile than other skunks and climbs well.

19–33 cm
7½–13 in

long hairs on tail
and back rise when
animal is alarmed

STRIPED SKUNK
Mephitis mephitis

This nocturnal omnivore ranges from Canada to Mexico. It does not hibernate but can experience periods of torpor in winter.

17–40 cm
6½–16 in



20–32 cm
8–12½ in

HUMBOLDT'S HOG-NOSED SKUNK
Conepatus humboldtii

A native of S. Chile and Argentina, this small skunk detects underground invertebrate prey by scent and digs it up.

28–31 cm
11–12 in

HOODED SKUNK
Mephitis macroura

This widespread C. American skunk occupies a range of habitats, feeding opportunistically on fruits, eggs, and small animals.

white stripe
warns predators
of foul secretions



RACCOONS AND RELATIVES

Raccoons, kinkajous, and olingos of the family Procyonidae are nimble New World carnivores. Most species are omnivorous and eat mainly plant material – especially fruits – and also insects, snails, small birds, and mammals. The raccoon is the largest of the group.

SOUTH AMERICAN COATI
Nasua nasua

This species lives in loose female-dominated colonies. An agile climber, it mainly eats fruits, supplemented out of season with animal prey.

43–58 cm
17–23 in



WHITE-NOSED COATI
Nasua narica

This social C. American omnivore spends the day foraging at ground level. It climbs well, however, and often sleeps in trees.

tail has faint
dark rings



RED PANDA

This tree-dwelling, herbivorous mammal is now placed in its own family, the Ailuridae. Previously, zoologists had classified it with the bears but now it is thought to be most closely related to the group that includes skunks, raccoons, and weasels.



RED PANDA
Ailurus fulgens

This raccoon-like mammal inhabits temperate forest in the Himalayas. It eats bamboo, fruits, small animals, and birds' eggs.

51–78 cm
20–30¾ in

WEASELS AND RELATIVES

Members of the family Mustelidae occur throughout Eurasia, Africa, and the Americas. They are characterized by a sinuous body and short legs, though the badgers and wolverines are more robust. Most are active predators and good swimmers.



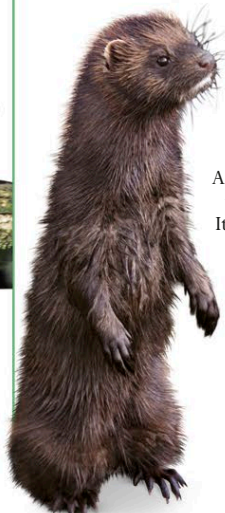
20–36 cm
8–14 in

EUROPEAN MINK
Mustela lutreola

A semi-aquatic predator, this species was once widespread in C. and W. Europe, but is now much less common than the introduced American mink.

AMERICAN MINK
Neovison vison

A fierce and stealthy predator, this mink is also a skilled swimmer. It has been introduced worldwide by fur farmers.



30–43 cm
12–17 in



tail has conspicuous
black tip